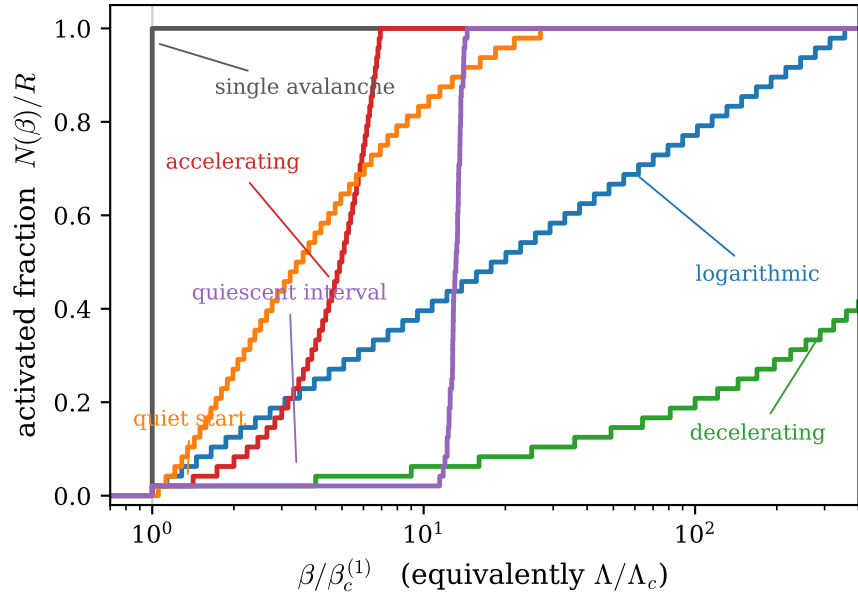


(a) cascade counting function

(b) rate: slope $= (1-a)/a$; accel. iff slope > 0 iff $s > 2$ 